Features of GUI

Graphical User Interface

Graphical User Interface is sometimes shortened to GUI (pronounced "gooey"). The user chooses an option – usually by pointing a mouse at an icon representing that option, then clicking to select.

Features of a GUI include:

- The four features of A Graphical User Interface (GUI) are constituted of four main parts – Windows, Icons, Menus and Pointer.
- Much easier to use for beginners
- Enable an easy exchange of information between software using cut and paste, or 'drag and drop'
- Use a lot of memory and processing power (can be slower than command line interfaces operated by expert users)
- Can be irritating to experienced users when simple tasks require a number of operations

When discussing user interfaces, it is important to note that Windows XP, Windows Vista, Apple OSX and Ubuntu all have GUIs.

A good GUI should:

- Be attractive and pleasing to the eye
- Allow the user to try out different options easily
- Be easy to use
- Use suitable colours for key areas
- Use words that are easy to understand aimed at the type of user
- Have help documentation

It should also consider the needs of the users. For example, young children are likely to prefer pictures to words and people with disabilities may benefit from particular input or output devices.

Developers will also use mock up tools to create proposed user interfaces. The mock up will identify all labels, text components, icons, menus, form fields and graphic components.

Principles for good GUI design

Generally accepted principles for Graphical user interface design are:

1. **Aesthetically pleasing** Provide visual appeal by following these presentation and graphic design principles:

2. **Clarity** The interface should be visually, conceptually and linguistically clear, including

3. **Compatibility** Provide compatibility with the following:

4. **Comprehensibility** A system should be easily understood and learned. A user should know the following

5. **Configurability** Permit easy personalization, configuration and reconfiguration of settings.

6. **Consistency** A system should look, act, and operate the same throughput. Similar components should:.

7. **Control** The user must control the interaction.

8. **Directness** Provide direct ways to accomplish tasks

9. **Efficiency**

10. **Familiarity** Employ familiar concepts and use a language that is familiar to the user.

11. **Flexibility** A system must be flexible to the different needs of its users, enabling a level and type of performance based upon:

12. **Forgiveness**

13. **Predictability** The user's should be able to anticipate the natural progression of the task.

14. **Recovery** A system should permit:

15. **Responsiveness** The system must rapidly respond to the user's requests.

16. **Simplicity**

17. **Transparency**

18. **Trade-offs**